

RAMDEOBABA UNIVERSITY

Department of Computer Science & Engineering

RENTIFY

One-Stop Rental Assistance Platform

TECHNICAL REPORT

Transparent Rental Decision Support

DISCOVER → VERIFY → UNDERSTAND → DECIDE

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1. Abstract

Rentify is a unified rental assistance platform designed to help renters make safer and more informed rental decisions. It approaches rental search as more than a property-discovery problem: renters also need to evaluate authenticity, verification status, locality context, safety considerations, scam risks and rental guidance.

The proposed platform brings these concerns together through the workflow DISCOVER → VERIFY → UNDERSTAND → DECIDE. It provides role-specific workflows for customers/renters, property owners/vendors, administrators and verification partners. The verification concept uses Pending → In-Review → Verified / Flagged, while the assistance module provides scam awareness, legal and tenancy guidance and government housing-scheme information.

The current implementation is an interactive frontend prototype built with React 19, React Router 7, Tailwind CSS, Lucide React and Vite. Prototype state is maintained using React Context and browser local storage. The prototype uses simulated data; production backend services, persistent databases, live registry integrations, machine-learning recommendation and AI-assisted document verification are not implemented.

The contribution is therefore integration, transparency and renter-centric decision support, rather than a claim of a completely new algorithm.

2. Introduction

2.1 Background

Rental housing supports mobility for students, first-time renters, relocating professionals and families. A rental decision, however, requires more than finding a listing. Renters may need to compare rent and deposit, understand locality and safety, establish listing credibility, identify scam risks and understand rental responsibilities.

The Rentify research validation identifies recurring patterns including stolen or reused photographs, below-market offers, listings for properties that are already occupied or unavailable, upfront token or advance-payment requests, misleading verification or premium charges, and ownership or identity discrepancies. It also notes that Indian rental-market estimates vary substantially by methodology and should be quoted with their source rather than as a single settled figure.

2.2 Problem Statement

The rental process is fragmented and trust-sensitive. Property listings, locality information, safety information, legal guidance and scam-awareness resources may be distributed across different sources.

- Fragmented information: property, locality, safety and rental guidance are often separated.
- Verification difficulty: renters may struggle to establish whether a listing and its lister are legitimate.
- Scam exposure: fake or duplicated listings, misleading information and advance-payment requests can create financial risk.
- Scattered guidance: tenancy rights, documentation, scam awareness and housing-support information may require separate research.
- Decision complexity: renters must combine several signals before deciding.

Rentify therefore addresses the need for a unified rental assistance platform combining property discovery, structured verification, contextual information and rental guidance.

2.3 Motivation

The motivation is to shift rental search from simple listing discovery toward transparent decision support. Existing platforms provide substantial discovery functionality, while research separately examines recommendation, fraud detection, verification and location-aware systems. Rentify focuses on integrating these concerns around the point at which a renter makes a decision.

2.4 Target Users

User group	Role in Rentify
Students	Primary renters who may be unfamiliar with a locality and vulnerable to misleading offers.
First-time renters	Users needing structured property, verification and rental guidance.
Relocating professionals	Users moving between cities/localities and requiring efficient comparison.
Migrant families	Renters who may need contextual locality and rental guidance.
Property owners / Vendors	Supply-side users who submit properties and ownership information.
Admin / Registrar	Manages listing review and verification operations.
Verification Partner	Performs field-level verification for assigned properties.

2.5 Project Scope

In scope: rental discovery, search/filtering, property details, verification workflow, administrative review, field verification, verified/flagged states, safety and credibility information, tenant feedback, scam awareness, legal/tenancy guidance and government housing-scheme information.

Current prototype: interactive frontend with simulated data and browser local storage. Proposed production: backend APIs, persistent database, authentication, secure document handling, external services and advanced recommendation/risk analysis.

3. Literature Review

3.1 Rental Recommendation

Polohakul et al. (2021) studied a hybrid session-based and content-based approach for real-estate recommendation and the item cold-start problem. Nguyen et al. (2023) examined context-based recommendation using user profiles and browsing context. These studies support the relevance of recommendation and contextual information to property discovery.

3.2 Fake Listing / Fraud Detection

Mohd Amin et al. (2024) investigated clustering-based classification of fake real-estate listings using K-means and distance-based analysis. This supports the use of listing characteristics as potential risk signals. Rentify does not implement a trained fraud classifier in the current prototype.

The project research also documents rental-fraud patterns. The FBI IC3 figure of 11,578 real-estate-fraud victims in 2021 is U.S. data and is used only as evidence that real-estate fraud is a documented digital-fraud category, not as an Indian prevalence estimate.

3.3 Property Verification

Xue et al. (2021) proposed a blockchain-based housing rental system involving identity and property authentication and smart contracts. Bhanushali et al. (2020) explored blockchain-based property-ownership verification. Rentify adopts a lighter role-based workflow for its prototype rather than implementing blockchain infrastructure.

3.4 Location-Aware Recommendation

Levandowski et al. (2012) introduced LARS, a location-aware recommender system using spatial information with user and item ratings. Location context is relevant to Rentify because locality, nearby amenities, transit and safety can affect rental decisions.

3.5 Research Gap

The reviewed literature addresses recommendation, fraud detection, property verification and location-aware recommendation as distinct areas. The commercial landscape likewise contains discovery platforms, verification or managed-accommodation approaches and separate guidance resources.

The defensible gap is an integration gap: the reviewed landscape did not demonstrate a unified renter-facing workflow combining verification status, scam awareness, safety information, rental/legal guidance and contextual property information around the property decision. The contribution is integration and

transparency, not a claim that individual features are new.

4. Existing System Analysis

4.1 NoBroker

Reviewed for direct-owner-oriented rental discovery and brokerage-reduction positioning.

4.2 99acres

Reviewed for large-scale property discovery and its owner, broker and developer ecosystem.

4.3 MagicBricks

Reviewed as a major property discovery and listing platform covering multiple locations and property categories.

4.4 Housing.com

Reviewed for property discovery, locality information and listing-data verification practices. Listing-data verification is distinct from independent ownership-document verification.

4.5 Managed Rental Platforms

Stanza Living, NestAway and Zolo were reviewed to understand managed accommodation and co-living models, which differ from Rentify's independent-owner verification workflow.

4.6 Comparative Analysis

Capability	NoBroker	99acres	Housing.com	MagicBricks	Managed	Rentify
Property discovery	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Owner/property verification	Limited	Limited	Listing-data	Limited	Managed	Proposed
Physical verification workflow	Not central	Not central	Not central	Not central	Managed	Proposed
Scam awareness	Limited	Limited	Guidance	Limited	Varies	✓
Legal/tenancy guidance	Partial	Partial	Available	Partial	Service-specific	✓
Location/context	✓	✓	✓	✓	Property-specific	✓
Government housing guidance	Limited	Limited	Limited	Limited	Limited	✓
Tenant feedback	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Unified decision support	Partial	Partial	Partial	Partial	Different model	Proposed

The comparison is not intended to claim that existing platforms are deficient. Different platforms address different parts of the rental journey. Rentify focuses on their integration within a transparent renter-facing workflow.

5. Proposed System

5.1 Rentify Concept

Rentify is a unified rental assistance platform combining property discovery, property/listing verification, contextual location information and rental guidance to help renters make safer and more informed rental decisions.

The platform is positioned as Transparent Rental Decision Support. It is not presented as the first or only rental platform in India.

5.2 DISCOVER → VERIFY → UNDERSTAND → DECIDE

Stage	Purpose	Representative actions
DISCOVER	Find suitable properties	Search, locality, city, BHK/type, rent and verification filters
VERIFY	Understand trust signals	Review verification status, ownership and field-audit information

Stage	Purpose	Representative actions
UNDERSTAND	Evaluate context and risks	Details, safety, credibility, scam, legal and scheme guidance
DECIDE	Make an informed decision	Combine available evidence before proceeding

5.3 System Features

- Property discovery and filtering.
- Property details including rent, deposit, specifications, amenities, safety and credibility.
- Verification lifecycle: Pending → In-Review → Verified / Flagged.
- Field-verification checklist and discrepancy reporting.
- Rental assistance covering scams, tenancy/legal guidance and housing schemes.
- Tenant feedback and credibility information.
- Role-based workflows for four primary roles.

5.4 User Roles

Role	Responsibilities
Customer / Renter	Explore, filter, inspect details, review verification, access assistance and submit feedback.
Vendor / Owner	Submit properties, provide ownership information and track status.
Admin / Registrar	Review submissions, assign partners, monitor visits and manage outcomes.
Verification Partner	Perform field checks, record observations and confirm or flag listings.

6. Requirements

6.1 Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
FR-01	Browse available rental properties.
FR-02	Search/filter by city, property type/BHK, maximum rent and verification status.
FR-03	Display rent, deposit, locality, area, lister, amenities, safety and verification status.
FR-04	Allow vendors to submit rental properties.
FR-05	Capture ownership-document type and registration information.
FR-06	Provide administrative review queue.
FR-07	Allow partner assignment.
FR-08	Support physical verification checklist.
FR-09	Maintain Pending, In-Review, Verified and Flagged states.
FR-10	Record discrepancies and flag listings.
FR-11	Provide scam, legal/tenancy and housing-scheme guidance.
FR-12	Allow ratings and feedback.
FR-13	Present verification and credibility indicators.
FR-14	Provide role-specific workflows.

6.2 Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
NFR-01	Usability
NFR-02	Responsive interface
NFR-03	Responsive search/filter performance

ID	Requirement
NFR-04	Production security
NFR-05	Privacy and data minimization
NFR-06	Reliable and traceable verification records
NFR-07	Modular maintainability
NFR-08	Production scalability
NFR-09	Transparent verification information
NFR-10	Explainable ranking
NFR-11	Production availability
NFR-12	Auditability

6.3 Use Cases

Use Case	Actor	Outcome
UC-01 Search property	Customer	Relevant listings displayed.
UC-02 View details	Customer	Property and verification context available.
UC-03 Access assistance	Customer	Guidance displayed.
UC-04 Submit property	Vendor	Listing enters workflow.
UC-05 Review listing	Admin	Proceed, assign or flag.
UC-06 Assign partner	Admin	Listing enters field stage.
UC-07 Physical verification	Partner	Confirm or report discrepancy.
UC-08 Verify/flag	Admin / Partner	Appropriate listing status.
UC-09 Feedback	Customer	Feedback added to credibility information.

7. System Design

7.1 System Architecture

The proposed production architecture separates presentation, application logic, persistent data and external services. The current prototype validates user-facing workflows without implementing the production backend or database.

Logical flow: Users → React Interface → Authentication/Authorization → Backend REST APIs → Application Services → Database / External Services.

7.2 Module Architecture

Module	Core responsibilities
Customer	Discovery, filters, details, verification visibility, assistance and feedback.
Vendor	Property submission, ownership information and status tracking.
Admin	Review queue, partner assignment, visit monitoring and status management.
Verification Partner	Assigned visits, field checklist, observations and confirmation/flagging.
Rental Assistance	Scam, legal/tenancy and government-scheme guidance.
Property & Verification	Listing lifecycle, verification records, field audits and discrepancies.
Feedback & Credibility	Ratings, comments and credibility-related display.

7.3 Data Flow

- 1 Property submission: Vendor → Property Details → Ownership Information → Verification Queue.
- 2 Verification: Admin → Review → Partner Assignment → Field Verification → Result → Status.

- 3 Customer discovery: Customer → Search/Filter → Listing Data → Details → Verification/Context → Decision.
- 4 Assistance: Customer → Assistance Portal → Scam / Legal / Government Guidance.
- 5 Feedback: Customer → Rating/Comment → Feedback → Property Information.

7.4 Verification Workflow

Vendor Submission → Admin Review → Partner Assignment → Physical Verification → Verified / Flagged

- Pending: submitted and awaiting review.
- In-Review: verification process/field visit is active.
- Verified: defined prototype checks are satisfactory and verification information is displayed.
- Flagged: discrepancy or risk signal is recorded and a warning is displayed.

The prototype checklist includes GPS/locality confirmation, original Index II inspection, physical keys/vacancy checks and available society/guard confirmation. Verification is intended to reduce risk and improve transparency, not guarantee a risk-free transaction.

8. Methodology

8.1 Overall Methodology

Rentify follows DISCOVER → VERIFY → UNDERSTAND → DECIDE, supported by role-specific workflows from property submission to customer evaluation.

8.2 Property Verification

Vendor submits property and ownership information; Admin reviews and assigns a Verification Partner; the partner performs an on-site checklist; the listing becomes Verified or Flagged. The prototype simulates document and field verification.

8.3 Recommendation / Ranking

The current prototype uses deterministic ranking rather than machine learning. Verified listings are prioritized, followed by credibility score and lower rent when otherwise comparable. Customers can filter by city, type/BHK, maximum rent and verification status.

Future work may introduce content-based, collaborative, hybrid or context-aware recommendation with explainable criteria.

8.4 Scam Detection Approach

The prototype combines risk awareness with discrepancy handling. Considered patterns include fake/reused listings, unrealistically low prices, upfront token requests, fake verification charges, identity/ownership inconsistencies and unauthorized subletting.

No trained machine-learning scam classifier is implemented. Future detection could combine rule-based signals with models using price anomalies, duplicate information, suspicious text, image reuse, unusual behaviour and identity/document inconsistencies.

8.5 Rental Assistance

The assistance module provides scam awareness, legal and tenancy rights, and government housing-scheme information. It is also accessible from the property-detail Decision Guidance Hub.

9. Technology Stack

9.1 Frontend

Technology	Status / purpose
React 19	Implemented; component-based interface.

Technology	Status / purpose
React Router 7	Implemented; client-side navigation.
Tailwind CSS	Implemented; responsive styling.
Lucide React	Implemented; interface icons.
Vite	Implemented; development/build tool.
React Context	Implemented; shared prototype state.
Browser Local Storage	Implemented; demo-state persistence.

9.2 Backend — Proposed

No backend server is included in the current prototype. A production version can use Node.js and Express.js for REST APIs covering authentication, listing management, verification, feedback, assistance and external-service communication.

9.3 Database — Proposed

The current prototype does not use MongoDB or PostgreSQL. Production storage can use MongoDB or PostgreSQL for users, properties, ownership information, verification records, field audits, feedback, assistance content and audit logs.

9.4 APIs and Services

The prototype does not depend on live external APIs for its core workflow. Production may integrate mapping/location, notification and appropriate government or registry services where technically and legally available.

9.5 Development Tools

- Visual Studio Code — development environment.
- Git — version control.
- GitHub — repository hosting and documentation.
- Browser Developer Tools — UI, console and local-storage inspection.
- Postman — proposed API testing.
- Jest — proposed automated testing.

10. Implementation

10.1 Prototype Architecture

The prototype is an interactive React application with landing, role-specific interfaces, property details and rental assistance. Main routes are: /, /customer, /property/:id, /vendor, /admin, /partner and /assistance.

Shared Rentify context manages listings, current role, audit logs, feedback and actions including listing submission, partner assignment, listing decisions, verification, feedback and demo reset. Browser local storage preserves prototype state.

10.2 Customer Module

Customers can search by locality/title/owner, filter by Verified Only, city, property type/BHK and maximum rent, and view listing cards with status, locality, safety, rent, deposit and trust information. Property details provide specifications, amenities, verification/field-audit information, feedback and the Decision Guidance Hub.

10.3 Vendor Module

Vendors can view dashboard statistics and select Submit New Property. The form captures title, city, locality, type, rent, deposit, description, ownership-proof information, document type, registration number and government-ID information. Document attachment is simulated.

10.4 Admin Module

Admins can view Review Queue, Active Visits and Certified metrics; review listings; assign verification partners; flag listings with a reason; monitor visits; and inspect listing records. The prototype also contains an approval-on-documents option, while the intended primary workflow remains Vendor → Admin → Verification Partner → Verified / Flagged.

10.5 Verification Partner Module

The partner portal shows assigned visits and the on-site checklist: GPS/locality confirmation, original Index II inspection, physical keys/vacancy confirmation and society/guard ownership confirmation. The partner can select Confirm (Issue Official Stamp) or Flag Discrepancy.

10.6 Assistance Module

The Assistance Module contains Documented Scam Typologies, Legal & Tenancy Rights and Government Housing Schemes. It is available as a full portal and from property details. Content is structured frontend content rather than live external retrieval.

11. Testing and Validation

11.1 Testing Strategy

Testing is primarily functional, scenario-based and workflow-oriented because the current system is an interactive prototype.

- Functional testing of search, filters, forms, status changes, verification actions and feedback.
- Workflow testing across Vendor → Admin → Verification Partner → Verified/Flagged → Customer.
- UI testing for navigation, buttons, forms, status indicators and responsive layout.
- State/persistence testing using React Context and browser local storage.

11.2 Test Cases

ID	Scenario	Expected result
TC-01	Open landing page	Role options load.
TC-02	Select Customer	Customer interface opens.
TC-03	Search listing	Matching listings displayed.
TC-04	City filter	Listings filtered by city.
TC-05	BHK/type filter	Matching types displayed.
TC-06	Maximum-rent filter	Listings above limit excluded.
TC-07	Verified Only	Only verified listings displayed.
TC-08	Property details	Property information displayed.
TC-09	Verified property	Verification information displayed.
TC-10	Flagged property	Warning/discrepancy displayed.
TC-11	Assistance	Assistance portal displayed.
TC-12	Vendor submission	Listing enters workflow.
TC-13	Assign partner	Listing moves to In-Review.
TC-14	Admin flag	Flagged state with reason.
TC-15	Field verification	Checklist and action available.
TC-16	Confirm verification	Listing becomes Verified.
TC-17	Report discrepancy	Listing becomes Flagged.
TC-18	Feedback	Feedback added.
TC-19	Reset Demo	Initial demo state restored.

ID	Scenario	Expected result
TC-20	Refresh	Relevant state persists locally.

The table defines validation scenarios. Actual pass/fail execution records should be completed during the final testing cycle rather than fabricated.

11.3 Validation

The prototype validates the feasibility of the proposed workflows: customer discovery and evaluation, vendor submission, administrative review and assignment, partner field verification, assistance and feedback. It also validates the conceptual Pending → In-Review → Verified / Flagged lifecycle.

11.4 Limitations

- Frontend-only; no production backend/API.
- Simulated data rather than a real rental dataset.
- Browser local storage rather than a production database.
- Simulated document verification rather than independent authentication.
- No live registry integration.
- No machine-learning recommendation or trained fraud classifier.
- No AI document-authenticity model.
- No production authentication/authorization.
- No production security, scalability or availability guarantees.
- No controlled real-world user study or quantified impact evaluation.

12. Results and Observations

12.1 Prototype Results

Area	Demonstrated result
Customer	Search/filter, details, verification visibility, assistance and feedback.
Vendor	Property submission and status tracking.
Admin	Review queue, partner assignment, active visits and flagging.
Verification Partner	Assigned visits, checklist, confirmation and discrepancy reporting.
Lifecycle	Pending → In-Review → Verified / Flagged.
Assistance	Scam, legal/tenancy and housing-scheme guidance.
Decision support	Property, verification and contextual information brought together.

12.2 Observations

- Integrating discovery, verification information and guidance creates a more structured decision-support workflow.
- Visible verification states improve transparency around trust-related information.
- Role separation clarifies responsibilities.
- The verification lifecycle provides a clear operational representation.
- Flagged listings demonstrate how potential risk can be surfaced.
- Rental assistance can be presented in context.
- Deterministic ranking is predictable but not an advanced recommender.
- Major workflows can be demonstrated without backend infrastructure.

Result boundary: these are prototype/workflow observations and do not establish quantified reductions in fraud, search time or financial loss.

13. Future Scope

Future area	Potential enhancement
AI document verification	OCR, information extraction, consistency checks and suspicious-pattern analysis with human oversight
Advanced recommendation	Content-based, collaborative, hybrid and context-aware recommendation.
Mobile application	Customer discovery and GPS-enabled field verification.
Multilingual support	English, Hindi, Marathi and additional languages based on deployment needs.
Production architecture	Backend APIs, persistent database, authentication, secure documents, external services and audit rec
Advanced fraud detection	Rule-based signals combined with machine-learning models.
AI chatbot	Conversational rental assistance.
Multi-city expansion	Extension beyond initial demonstration locations.
Roommate matching	Future support for shared-rental requirements.

The roadmap can progress from the current interactive prototype to a full-stack MVP and then to advanced capabilities such as AI-assisted document analysis, recommendation, risk analysis, mobile and multilingual support.

14. Conclusion

Rentify addresses rental decision-making as a trust, information and context problem rather than only a listing-discovery problem. The project proposes a unified workflow combining property discovery, explicit verification status, contextual information, scam awareness, rental guidance and feedback.

The prototype demonstrates DISCOVER → VERIFY → UNDERSTAND → DECIDE through four role-specific interfaces and a structured verification lifecycle. It provides a practical proof of concept for how renters, owners, administrators and field-verification partners can interact within a common system.

The technical contribution is intentionally positioned as integration, transparency and renter-centric decision support. Existing research and commercial systems already provide individual capabilities; Rentify brings relevant concerns together around the rental decision.

The prototype is not presented as production-ready. Backend services, persistent storage, secure document handling, live external verification, advanced recommendation and AI-assisted document analysis remain proposed or future capabilities.

15. References

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[9] NoBroker, rental/property discovery and tenant-guidance resources.

[10] 99acres, rental/property discovery platform resources.

[11] MagicBricks, rental/property discovery platform resources.

[12] Housing.com, property discovery and verification-related resources.

[13] Government and institutional sources reviewed for rental guidance and housing schemes, as documented in the Rentify reference repository.

Reference note: market-size estimates vary substantially by definition and source; the Rentify research validation recommends attributing estimates to their source rather than presenting an unsupported single figure.

16. Appendices

Appendix A — Screenshots

The final report is intended to include approved screenshots of the working Rentify prototype. The project team is maintaining the screenshot set separately under 12_Screenshots/. No fabricated screenshots are included here.

Suggested screenshot	Purpose
Landing / role selection	Shows the four role entry points and platform positioning.
Customer discovery	Shows search, filters, listing cards and verification visibility.
Property details	Shows property information, verification/audit information and guidance.
Vendor dashboard	Shows listing statistics and property submission.
Admin dashboard	Shows review queue, partner assignment and status management.
Verification Partner portal	Shows field-verification checklist and actions.
Rental Assistance portal	Shows scam, legal/tenancy and government-scheme guidance.

Appendix B — Diagrams

The project maintains five completed diagrams under 11_Diagrams/. The approved image files should be inserted into the final report when the report is assembled with the team's final visual assets.

Diagram	Purpose
System-Architecture.png	High-level proposed architecture and system layers.
User-Flow.png	Role-oriented rental journey and decision flow.
Data-Flow-Diagram.png	Movement of property, verification and decision-support information.
Verification-Workflow.png	Pending → In-Review → Verified / Flagged lifecycle.
Module-Architecture.png	Major Rentify modules and relationships.

The report deliberately does not recreate or fabricate the team's approved diagram artwork. The original diagram files in the repository should remain the authoritative visual versions.